

Proxy War x Softmax

Purpose: Share what actually happened, compare it with the cold-start model Emmett already described, and determine whether Softmax wants a concrete next step with Proxy War.

POSITIONING

Proxy War is a live external Coworld with a functioning league and a small number of genuinely engaged policy builders. It has not yet demonstrated broad demand or a repeatable way to recruit and retain participants.

Emmett's model is already clear: seed 3-10 competent agents and provide an easy starter policy and optimization toolchain; competition, learning, exploration, and social connection may then sustain participation. Apply that model to Proxy War's evidence - do not ask him to explain it again.

WHAT WE ACTUALLY KNOW

Platform snapshot: 19 Jul 2026, 01:01 Lisbon. Refresh before the call.

- 1 **Hosted system works.** proxywar : 0.1.10 is canonical; 5/5 hosted smokes and 10/10 certification stages passed.
- 2 **An operating field exists.** Round 517 had 13 policy entrants. Auri's v42 was rank 3 after 381 automated rounds. This is activity, not 13 engaged people or proof of demand.
- 3 **Engagement is concentrated.** A few onboarded people actively iterate; most people approached were not interested enough to begin. Reasons are not systematically measured.
- 4 **Iteration defects are real.** One tester thought games never ran because activity was invisible; logs and durable replays are problematic. The retention effect is unmeasured.

OBSERVATIONS, NOT CONCLUSIONS

- 1 **Small engaged niche; audience unknown.** Some builders engage deeply, but most outreach has not converted.
- 2 **Friction exists among interested builders.** Docker, registration, setup, and competence are obstacles. We do not know if removing them increases demand.
- 3 **Evidence problems impede iteration.** We have defects and anecdotes, not causal retention evidence.

CONDITIONAL TEST OF THE EXISTING MODEL

Only if Softmax believes Proxy War is worth helping: test whether fully executing its cold-start model changes the participation funnel.

TOGETHER, DEFINE

- The remaining gap between Proxy War today and the 3-10-agent plus starter/toolchain model.
- One concrete Softmax contribution: policy or tournament entry, recruitment, customer introductions, or product help.
- A funnel: approached, interested, setup, first match, competence, second version.
- Short exit interviews at each drop-off point.

RECIPROCAL ROLES

- **Auri:** complete the agreed developer-owned gap, operate the league, record the funnel, and interview participants.
- **Softmax:** name a counterpart, make the agreed contribution, and help on blockers the test encounters.
- **Day 30:** decide whether demand justifies more investment and which bottleneck, if any, dominates.

FIVE DECISIONS TO LEAVE WITH

- 1 **Fit.** Is Proxy War one of the external Coworlds Softmax believes is worth helping?
- 2 **Gap.** Against the model Emmett described, what specific gap does Softmax see in Proxy War today?
- 3 **Support.** What would 'find customers or promote' concretely mean for Proxy War?
- 4 **Next step.** Is one bounded joint test worthwhile, who owns it, and when is review?
- 5 **Public narrative.** Is the hold active, and is 'first external Coworld' publicly usable?

CLOSING ASK

Based on what you have seen, is Proxy War something Softmax wants to help test and grow? If yes, what is one concrete contribution from each side, and what result would we review?